DRAFT PROJECT for internal use #

Cross-Border Reintegration Programme for Forensic Psychiatric Patients

Commissioning Authority: Ministry of Justice of the Netherlands
Implementing Partners: CBT Veldzicht + TBS Gronningen + Fundacja Niwyja Poland
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Programme Overview

Since November 2023, Fundacja Niwyja from Poland has been implementing a cross-border programme encompassing the transfer and social reintegration of Polish nationals hospitalised in closed forensic psychiatric facilities in the Netherlands.
The programme participants are individuals subject to TBS orders (terbeschikkingstelling — the Dutch equivalent of a security measure involving placement in a psychiatric institution), who hold Polish citizenship and are subject to repatriation. In many cases, these individuals have exhausted available therapeutic options in foreign facilities, and their continued rehabilitation in the host country is not feasible due to their immigration status.

Pioneering Nature of the Programme

The Cross-Border Reintegration Programme for Forensic Psychiatric Patients has been entirely designed, developed, and implemented as an integrated framework combining clinical care, legal supervision, community-based monitoring, and cross-jurisdictional reporting within a single, cohesive programme.

Programme Objectives

To provide a comprehensive, supervised reintegration pathway for patients on Polish territory, encompassing:

- Psychiatric assessment and stabilisation in an inpatient setting
- Continuation and optimisation of pharmacotherapy
- Gradual community-based resocialisation under supervision
- Vocational activation and progression towards independent living
- Ongoing risk management and reporting to foreign authorities

Funding opportunities for cross-border forensic psychiatry repatriation

The EU Justice Programme's JUST-2026-JCOO call is the single most strategically relevant funding source for this project, explicitly covering Framework Decision 2008/909/JHA on cross-border transfer of persons under custodial measures, with a deadline of 22 April 2026. Beyond this anchor opportunity, the research identified 25+ open or announced funding calls across EU programmes, EEA/Norway Grants, Interreg, and private foundations — collectively offering a realistic multi-source financing strategy for a pilot project spanning forensic psychiatry, judicial cooperation, and social reintegration. The strongest opportunities cluster in three domains: EU justice instruments (JUST, CERV), the newly launched EEA/Norway Grants Poland Justice Programme (€60M, with Council of Europe partnership), and cross-border cooperation mechanisms (Interreg, Visegrad

Fund, Erasmus+).

Comprehensive table of all identified opportunities

#	Programme / Call	Funding Institution	Financing Type	Thematic Scope	Grant Size	Deadline	Status	URL	Relevance (1–5)	Justification
1	JUST-2026-JCOO — Judicial Cooperation in Criminal Matters (Priority 2)	DG Justice (EC)	Action grant, 90% co-financing	Cross-border transfer of custodial measures (FD 2008/909/JHA), mutual recognition, detention conditions, social rehabilitation	€75,000–€350,000	22 Apr 2026	OPEN	Call fiche (PDF)	5	Directly covers FD 2008/909 on transfer of persons under custodial measures including forensic psychiatric detention; explicitly funds social rehabilitation and cross-border judicial cooperation

2	JUST-2026-JTRA — Judicial Training (Criminal Law / Fundamental Rights)	DG Justice (EC)	Action grant, 90% co-financing	Training of justice professionals on mutual recognition instruments, detention rights, cross-border criminal law	From €4.075M pool	~Apr 2026	OPEN	Call fiche (PDF)	4	Could fund training for judges, prosecutors, and practitioners on legal frameworks governing cross-border forensic psychiatric patient transfers

3	EEA/ Norway Grants — Poland Justice Programme	EEA Financial Mechanism / Norway (via PL Ministry of Justice)	Grant	Judicial cooperation, rule of law, human rights in justice; Council of Europe as International Partner Organisation	From €60M programme	H1 2026 (calls imminent)	ANNOUNCED	eeagrants.org/ poland	5	€60M dedicated to justice in Poland; CoE partnership ensures forensic psychiatry/ cross-border cooperation aligns perfectly; programme agreement signed 4 Feb 2026

4	CERV-2026-CHAR-LITI — EU Charter of Fundamental Rights	DG Justice / EACEA	Action grant, ~90%	Fundamental rights awareness, strategic litigation, rights of detained persons, right to dignity and liberty	From €26M pool	15 Sep 2026	ANNOUNCED (opens 20 May 2026)	CERV portal	4	Covers fundamental rights of persons in forensic psychiatric detention; could fund rights-based advocacy and strategic litigation on patients' cross-border rights

5	Erasmus+ KA2 Cooperation Partnerships 2026	National Agencies (decentralised)	Lump sum grant	Cross-border partnerships for innovation in education/ training/ social inclusion; priority: inclusion and diversity, mental health	€120,000 / €250,000 / €400,000	5 Mar 2026	OPEN	Erasmus+ guide	4	Ideal for developing cross-border training and professional exchange on forensic psychiatric reintegration; requires ≥3 organisations from ≥3 countries

6	Erasmus+ KA2 Small-scale Partnerships 2026	National Agencies	Lump sum grant	Same priorities, designed for smaller/ grassroots NGOs	€30,000 or €60,000	5 Mar 2026	OPEN	Erasmus+ guide	3	Lower-budget entry point for piloting cross-border professional cooperation in forensic psychiatry; lower administrative burden

7	MSCA Staff Exchanges 2026 (MSCA-SE-2026)	REA (EC)	Grant (unit costs for secondments)	Inter-sectoral, interdisciplinary staff exchanges between academic and non-academic organisations; bottom-up (any topic)	€500,000–€1,500,000	16 Apr 2026	OPEN	MSCA portal	4	Enables structured staff exchanges between forensic psychiatry institutions, justice authorities, social work organisations, and NGOs across EU countries
8	CERV-2026-CITIZENS-CIV — Citizens' Engagement	EACEA	Action grant	Citizens' democratic participation, awareness of EU rights, cross-border civic engagement	From €30M pool	29 Apr 2026	OPEN	CERV portal	3	Could fund civic advocacy on rights of EU citizens detained in forensic facilities abroad

9	CERV-2026-DAPHNE — Violence Against Vulnerable Groups	EACEA	Action grant	Protection of vulnerable persons from violence including institutional violence	From €21M pool	10 Sep 2026	ANNOUNCED (opens 14 May 2026)	CERV portal	3	Relevant for addressing institutional violence/ abuse in closed psychiatric facilities; vulnerability of forensic patients
10	CERV-2026-CITIZENS-TOWN-NT — Networks of Towns	EACEA	Action grant	Municipal cooperation across borders on EU policy themes	From €12M pool	16 Apr 2026	OPEN	CERV portal	2	Could create municipal network focused on reintegration services for repatriated forensic patients

11	EEA/ Norway Grants — Civil Society Fund (Active Citizens)	EEA FMO (via national fund operators)	Grant for CSOs	Social justice, equality, human rights, anti-discrimination, civic participation	TBD (prev. €5K–€200K+)	Mid-late 2026	ANNOUNCED (fund operators being selected)	eeagrants.org	4	Specifically designed for NGOs / CSOs; rights-based advocacy for persons with psychosocial disabilities in detention
12	Visegrad Fund — Visegrad Grants	International Visegrad Fund	Grant, up to 100%	Democratic values, human rights, civil society, cross-border cooperation, social development	€20,000–€60,000	1 Jun 2026	ANNOUNCED (opens 1 May 2026)	visegradfund.org	4	Excellent for V4 network-building on forensic psychiatry cooperation; requires partners from ≥3 V4 countries (PL, CZ, SK, HU)

13	Horizon Europe CL2 TRANSFO-08 — Migration, Inclusion, and Health	REA	RIA, up to 100%	Cross-border inclusion, integration, health of persons moving across jurisdictions	~€3–4M per project	23 Sep 2026	ANNOUNCED (opens 15 May 2026)	Horizon Europe CL2	3	Cross-border health and inclusion aligns with forensic psychiatric transfer/reintegration; requires large research consortium
14	Horizon Europe CL2 TRANSFO-09 — Long-term Care Policy	REA	RIA, up to 100%	Long-term care policy, community-based care, institutional care reform	~€3–4M per project	23 Sep 2026	ANNOUNCED (opens 15 May 2026)	Horizon Europe CL2	3	Long-term psychiatric care in closed facilities and community reintegration pathways fit this scope

15	HORIZON-HLTH-2026-01-DISEASE-09 — Multisectoral NCD Approach	HaDEA	RIA	Implementation research on NCDs across health, justice, and social sectors	~€2–5M per project	~Sep 2026	ANNOUNCED	HaDEA	3	Mental disorders as NCDs; multisectoral framing (health + justice + social) directly aligns with project's cross-sector nature
16	HORIZON-HLTH-2026-01-CARE-01 — Healthcare Access Innovation	HaDEA	IA	Innovative healthcare access, integrated care approaches	Part of €90M + call	16 Apr 2026	OPEN	HaDEA	3	Could frame cross-border healthcare access for forensic psychiatric patients as integrated care innovation

17	ESF+ Social Innovation+ (EaSI) — Future Transnational Calls	European Competence Centre for Social Innovation	Lump sum grant, 80% co-financing	Social experimentation, social innovation transfer/ scaling, social protection, social inclusion	Typically €1–3M	TBA (monitor)	FORTHCOMING	socialinnovationplus.eu	4	The forensic psychiatric repatriation model is exactly the type of cross-border social experimentation EaSI funds; highly relevant when new call opens
18	Interreg Czechia–Poland (Priority 4: Institutional Cooperation)	CZ Min. of Regional Development / PL Min. of Development	ERDF co-financing, up to 80%	Cross-border institutional cooperation, social development	Variable (from €178.9M programme)	~20 May 2026 (rolling)	OPEN	cz-pl.eu	3	Priority 4 supports CZ-PL cross-border institutional cooperation on forensic psychiatry and reintegration services

19	Robert Bosch Stiftung	Robert Bosch Stiftung GmbH	Project grant	Health system innovation, German-Polish cooperation, social cohesion	Variable (no fixed limits)	Rolling	OPEN	bosch-stiftung.de	3	Strong interest in health care innovation and German-Polish cooperation; €151 M/ year in health alone
20	Open Society Foundations — Mental Health Initiative	OSF	Project grant / operating support	Deinstitutionalization, community-based alternatives, rights of persons with psychosocial disabilities	Variable	Ongoing (LOI/ invitation)	ONGOING	opensocietyfoundations.org	4	Strong focus on CEE psychiatric reform, deinstitutionalization, and community reintegration; most grants by invitation — direct outreach recommended

21	Foundation for German-Polish Cooperation (FWPN/ SdPZ)	FWPN (PL-DE bilateral)	Project co-financing	All sectors including health, justice, civil society; bilateral PL-DE focus	Variable	Rolling	OPEN	fwpn.org.pl	3	Could co-finance bilateral PL-DE component; Germany has extensive forensic psychiatric system
22	EU4Health 2026 Work Programme	HaDEA / DG SANTE	Grants and procurement	Mental health, cross-border healthcare, health system resilience	Prev. €200K–€10M+	Expected H2 2026	ANTICIPATED	hadea.ec.europa.eu	4	EU committed €1.23B to mental health; previous WPs funded mental health projects; high potential once 2026 WP published

23	Council of Europe + EEA/ Norway Grants Cooperation	CoE (as International Partner) via EEA/ Norway Grants	Cooperation programme	Justice, anti-discrimination, rule of law, countering threats to democracy	TBD	TBD 2026	ANNOUNCED	coe.int	5	CoE's 2024 Recommendation on mental health of prisoners directly aligns; CoE confirmed as partner in PL Justice Programme
24	MSCA Postdoctoral Fellowships 2026	REA	Fellowship grant	Bottom-up; any research topic; international mobility	€180,000–€280,000	9 Sep 2026	ANNOUNCED (opens 9 Apr 2026)	MSCA portal	2	Could host researcher studying cross-border forensic transfer legal frameworks; supplementary to main project

25	CERV-2026-CITIZENS-VALUES — Union Values	EC	Action grant	Rule of law, democracy, fundamental rights	From €110.75M pool	~9 Mar 2027	ANNOUNCED (opens Oct 2026)	CERV portal	3	Large-budget call covering rule of law and fundamental rights; longer-term planning option

Why JUST-2026-JCOO is the definitive match

The Justice Programme's JUST-2026-JCOO call (Priority 2: Criminal Matters) is the only EU funding instrument that explicitly names the legal basis for cross-border forensic psychiatric transfers. Framework Decision 2008/909/JHA governs the mutual recognition of custodial sentences and measures involving deprivation of liberty — the exact legal mechanism through which forensic psychiatric patients would be repatriated between EU Member States. The call explicitly funds projects that improve the practical application of this Framework Decision, enhance social rehabilitation and reintegration, and address detention conditions for vulnerable persons.
The grant range of €75,000–€350,000 at 90% EU co-financing makes this accessible for an NGO-led consortium. The requirement for at least two entities from two different EU countries aligns naturally with the project's cross-border architecture. The deadline of 22 April 2026 provides adequate preparation time. No other currently open call matches this level of thematic precision.

The EEA/Norway Grants represent the largest strategic opportunity

Poland is the single largest beneficiary of EEA/Norway Grants in the 2021–2028 period, receiving €924.9 million in total allocation. The dedicated Justice Programme receives €60 million, with the Council of Europe confirmed as International Partner Organisation. The programme agreement was signed on 4 February 2026 — just 11 days before this research date — meaning calls for proposals are imminent.
The programme covers judicial cooperation, rule of law, human rights in the justice system, and anti-discrimination. The Council of Europe's involvement is particularly significant: the CoE adopted its Recommendation CM/Rec(2024)4 on the mental health of prisoners and probationers in 2024, creating a direct policy link to forensic psychiatry repatriation. The project applicant should engage with the Programme Operator (Polish Ministry of Justice) immediately to position themselves for the first call publication.
The Civil Society Fund under EEA/Norway Grants provides a parallel track specifically designed for NGOs, with expected first calls in mid-to-late 2026 once fund operators are selected.

Erasmus+ and MSCA offer strong complementary pathways

Two often-overlooked instruments provide substantial added value. Erasmus+ KA2 Cooperation

Partnerships (deadline 5 March 2026 — less than three weeks away) offer lump-sum grants of up to €400,000 for cross-border partnerships developing innovative practices. The project could be framed as developing professional training and exchange of good practices in forensic psychiatric reintegration, with "inclusion and diversity" as the horizontal priority. The requirement for three organisations from three countries aligns well, and mental health and psycho-social well-being are explicitly listed among sector-specific priorities.
MSCA Staff Exchanges 2026 (deadline 16 April 2026) supports structured secondments between academic and non-academic organisations with grants of €500,000–€1,500,000. The forensic psychiatry field's inherent interdisciplinarity — spanning clinical psychiatry, law, social work, and public administration — makes it an ideal fit for inter-sectoral staff exchange. This mechanism could build the institutional capacity and professional networks that the repatriation model requires.

A multi-source strategy maximizes both funding and systemic impact

The most sophisticated approach involves treating these funding sources not as alternatives but as components of a layered financing architecture. Each programme funds a different dimension of what is inherently a multi-dimensional project:

- JUST-2026-JCOO funds the legal-judicial cooperation core (mutual recognition, transfer procedures, supervision)
- EEA/Norway Grants Justice Programme funds the systemic/institutional dimension in Poland (capacity building within the justice system)
- Erasmus+ KA2 funds professional development and cross-border knowledge exchange
- MSCA Staff Exchanges funds the research-practice transfer and interdisciplinary staffing
- CERV-2026-CHAR-LITI (September 2026) funds the fundamental rights and advocacy dimension
- Visegrad Fund (June 2026) funds regional V4 network-building as a preparatory action
- ESF+ Social Innovation+ (when available) funds the social experimentation and model-scaling dimension

This approach creates €1.5–3 million in aggregate potential funding while building the project's credibility through multiple EU-level endorsements.

The three most strategically relevant funding sources

1. JUST-2026-JCOO Priority 2 (Relevance: 5/5) — This is the project's natural home. Framework Decision 2008/909/JHA is the precise EU instrument governing cross-border transfer of custodial measures, and the call explicitly aims to improve its implementation while enhancing social rehabilitation of transferred persons. The call also covers FD 2008/947/JHA (supervision of probation measures) and detention conditions for vulnerable populations — both directly applicable to forensic psychiatric repatriation. An NGO-led consortium with a partner from the destination country of repatriation would be optimally positioned. Apply immediately; deadline 22 April 2026.
2. EEA/Norway Grants — Poland Justice Programme (Relevance: 5/5) — With €60 million dedicated to justice in Poland and the Council of Europe as an institutional partner, this represents the largest available funding pool with direct thematic alignment. The programme's scope encompasses everything from judicial cooperation to human rights in detention. The timing is ideal: the programme agreement was just signed, meaning the applicant can engage early with the Programme Operator (Ministry of Justice) and shape their proposal before formal call publication. The CoE partnership provides institutional legitimacy and access to European-wide standards on mental health in detention settings. Engage with Programme Operator now; calls expected H1 2026.
3. ESF+ Social Innovation+ / EaSI (Relevance: 4/5, strategic importance: 5/5) — While no call is currently open, the Social Innovation+ initiative under the EaSI strand is the EU's dedicated mechanism for precisely this type of project: cross-border social experimentation and policy

innovation. With grants of €1–3 million at 80% co-financing, it provides the scale needed for a genuine systemic pilot. The forensic psychiatric repatriation model — combining health, justice, and social services across borders — is a textbook case of social innovation requiring transnational experimentation before policy scaling. The European Competence Centre for Social Innovation publishes new calls throughout the year. Register on the SIM platform and monitor continuously; prepare a draft proposal for immediate submission when a thematically aligned call opens.

Conclusion

The funding landscape as of February 2026 is unusually favorable for this project. The convergence of a directly aligned Justice Programme call (JUST-2026-JCOO), the just-launched EEA/Norway Grants Polish Justice Programme, and the EU's heightened emphasis on mental health (€1.23 billion commitment) and mutual recognition in criminal matters creates a window of opportunity that did not exist two years ago. The project's cross-cutting nature — spanning health, justice, social policy, and international cooperation — is not a liability but an asset, as it opens eligibility across multiple programme lines. The critical next steps are: (1) begin preparation for JUST-2026-JCOO immediately (22 April deadline), (2) establish contact with the Polish Ministry of Justice as EEA/Norway Grants Programme Operator, and (3) submit an Erasmus+ KA2 application by 5 March 2026 as a quick-win partnership-building measure. The three-pronged approach positions the project to secure €500,000–€2 million in first-phase funding while building the consortium and evidence base needed for larger ESF+ Social Innovation applications in late 2026 or 2027.